

Seawall height in Oakland Park

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

OAKLAND PARK • BROWARD COUNTY

5.0

 ft NAVD88

New or substantially rehabilitated seawalls, seawall caps, canal banks or berms in Oakland Park must reach at least 5.0 ft NAVD88. Applications filed before 1 Jan 2035 can be approved at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if the wall is designed to be raised to 5.0 ft by 2050. The city code sets no maximum seawall height.

The detail

MINIMUM	5.0 ft NAVD88 - Code Sec. 14-1(b)
INTERIM	applications submitted before 1 Jan 2035 may be permitted at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if designed to accommodate 5.0 ft NAVD88 by 1 Jan 2050 - Sec. 14-1(b)
SUBSTANTIAL REPAIR	work on more than 50% of shoreline length or costing 50% or more of the structure's value - Sec. 14-1(a)
WHOLE SHORELINE	substantial repair/rehab must cover the entire shoreline - Sec. 14-1(g)
DOCKS	may be no higher than the adjacent seawall - Sec. 14-7
THE CITY CAN ORDER A WALL	Where the building official finds bank stabilization is needed to abate a nuisance or a danger to navigation, the owner must build a seawall or approved revetment - Sec. 14-1
PERMIT	From the building official, with plan approval from the Department of Planning and Environmental Protection; the application shows the mean water line, ground elevation and waterway width - Sec. 14-3
VARIANCES	Heard by the city commission; \$200 application fee, a newspaper notice at least 10 days ahead and mailed notice to property owners within three hundred feet - Sec. 14-8
DOCKS AND THE WALL	Docks must be built independent of the seawall unless sealed engineering shows the wall can carry the dock load. No docks on waterways under 50 ft wide; elsewhere up to 10% of width or 15 ft - Sec. 14-5, 14-7

Where this comes from: Oakland Park Code of Ordinances Ch. 14, Art. I, Sec. 14-1 (Ord. No. O-2022-015); Secs. 14-3, 14-5, 14-7, 14-8

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.